

Customise your prompt



If you want to configure your Command prompt, use the following code:

Code	Usage
<code>\!</code>	Current History number
<code>\\$</code>	Use \$ as prompt for all users except the root user.
<code>\d</code>	Current Date
<code>\#</code>	History command number for just the current shell
<code>\h</code>	Hostname
<code>\s</code>	SHELL type currently active
<code>\t</code>	Time of day
<code>\v</code>	Shell version
<code>\u</code>	Username
<code>\n</code>	Newline Character

Example: My current shell looks like what follows:

```
vikas@malviya:
```

To display time, instead of the above text I will use the command given below:

```
PS1="\t"
```

Now, it will look like what's shown below:

```
9:26:40
```

It takes the current system's time as the default shell prompt.



Note: Always use quoted string `PS1= "\t"` and not `PS1=\t`.

—Vikas Malviya, vm94@in.com

Mount Samba-sharing without 'root' access in Terminal



You can mount a Samba share with the following command:

```
mount -t smbfs -o username=[username],password=[password] //  
servername/share /mount/point
```

The `-t smbfs` denotes a Samba filesystem type, and `-o` passes the username and password of a user to access the `//servername/share` Samba share. This will be mounted on the local system at `/mount/point`.

To allow normal users to mount their Samba shares, the following code needs to be issued as the root user:

```
chmod +s /usr/bin/smbmnt
```

```
chmod +s /usr/bin/smbmount
```

A user can then mount and unmount a Samba share by using the following command:

```
smbmount //server/share /mount/point
```

```
smbumount /mount/point
```

—Aravindan, aravindanjp01@gmail.com

Save a file in Vim/Vi editor, which is opened without 'root' permission



Consider this: You are a systems admin, editing a file in the Vi editor, which requires 'root' level access. When you try to save it, you realise that you were editing the file in the normal user mode instead of the 'root' mode.

Since you require 'root' level access to save the file, you will have to first save it in some 'tmp' location and copy it back. To avoid doing this extra task, you can use the following command in the 'Vi' editor:

```
:w !sudo tee %
```

Where...

- `:w` stands for 'Write a file'.
 - `!sudo` for 'Call shell sudo command'.
 - `'tee'` is the output of the write (`'vim :w'`) command redirected, using `'tee'`.
 - `'%'`: The `'%'` is nothing but the current file name
- In simple words, the `'tee'` command is run as `'root'` and it takes the standard input and writes it to a file represented by `'%'`. However, this will prompt it to reload the file again (hit `'L'` to load changes in the Vim editor itself).

—Aravindan, aravindanjp01@gmail.com

END

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